```
// index.php

session_start();
$ curl -v http://localhost:8080/index.php
...
< Set-Cookie: PHPSESSID=3fe1329aa9a3575373814ebf8aa59857; path=/
```

Simply calling `session_start()` is enough to get PHP to generate a `PHPSESSID` cookie, and a file will be written to the configured filesystem path. The location of PHP session files is set with the `session.save_path` ini directive. If you are using the official PHP cli image to follow the examples at home, this location will be `/tmp` inside the container. Launch a shell inside your container with `docker run`, and you can see for yourself (use `docker ps` to obtain the container ID for your local environment; it will be different from the one given below in the text):

```
$ docker ps
CONTAINER ID   IMAGE...
0d72be74121b   php:8.4-cli...

$ docker exec -it 0d72be74121b bash
root@0d72be74121b:/usr/src/myapp# php --ini
Configuration File (php.ini) Path: /usr/local/etc/php
...

root@0d72be74121b:/usr/src/myapp# grep -rn "session.save_path" /usr/
local/etc/php
...
/usr/local/etc/php/php.ini-development:1292:;session.save_path = "/tmp"

root@0d72be74121b:/usr/src/myapp# ls /tmp
sess_3fe1329aa9a3575373814ebf8aa59857

root@0d72be74121b:/usr/src/myapp# cat /tmp/sess_3fe1329aa9a3575373814e
bf8aa59857
root@0d72be74121b:/usr/src/myapp#
```

Session data is automatically serialized (encoded into a string) when a request finishes and a script terminates, and the inverse happens when a script starts a session (usually as one of the first actions taken, or automatically on script start depending